

Creative Writing Handbook
2025-26

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MINOR REQUIREMENTS

WITHOUT THESIS

6 Courses, 24 Credits

1. 1000-Level Courses:
 - a. Reading For Writing
 - b. Introduction to Creative Writing
2. 2000-Level Courses:
 - a. 1 Craft of Writing Course in any genre
3. 3000-Level Courses:
 - a. 1 Workshop in any genre
 - b. 1 Workshop in any genre
 - c. 1 Workshop in any genre

Note:

- Up to 2 cross-listed courses are allowed
- No ISM and No TP credits will be counted towards the minor requirements

WITH THESIS

6 Courses, 24 Credits

1. 1000-Level Courses:
 - a. Reading For Writing
 - b. Introduction to Creative Writing
2. 2000-Level Courses:
 - a. 1 Craft of Writing Course in any genre
3. 3000-Level Courses:
 - a. 1 Workshop in any genre
 - b. 1 Workshop in any genre
 - c. Publishing Seminar
4. Thesis

THESIS GUIDELINES

- The Creative Writing Thesis is a year-long project that can be taken on in any genre.
- The word limit is 8000 words (6000 words for the creative component + 2000 words for the critical component) for prose & translation theses. For poetry & mixed-form theses, the word limit is to be determined with the advisor.
- You are required to reach out to an advisor with a proposal in the summer before the academic year you intend to work on your thesis.
- In the Spring of the thesis year, you are required to take the course Publishing Seminar.
- The thesis itself does not carry any credits in either Monsoon or Spring.

CONCENTRATION REQUIREMENTS

4 Courses, 16 Credits

1. 1000-Level Courses:
 - a. Reading For Writing
 - b. Introduction to Creative Writing
 2. 2000-Level Courses:
 - a. 1 Craft of Writing Course in any genre
 3. 3000-Level Courses:
 - a. 1 Workshop in any genre
- No ISM and No TP credits will be counted towards the concentration requirements

CAPSTONE PROJECT

2 Courses + Thesis, 12 Research Credits

In their 4th year, students may choose to do an advanced minor in Creating Writing provided they have completed a thesis and taken the Publishing Seminar in their 3rd year.

1. 4000-Level Courses:
 - a. 1 CW Critical Course
 - b. Publishing Seminar
2. Capstone Thesis

Capstone thesis word count & weight given to creative and critical components is to be determined with the advisor.

ENGLISH AND CREATIVE WRITING INTERDISCIPLINARY MAJOR

ENG-CW MAJOR IN THREE YEARS

15 Courses, 60 Credits

2 ENG Gateways (Forms of Literature + Introduction to Literary Theory)

3 ENG Surveys (of the four: Early British Literature, Literature in the Age of Empire, Indian Literatures, Postcolonial Literature)

2 CW Gateways (Reading for Writing, Introduction to Creative Writing)

1 ENG Critical Thinking Seminar (CTS)

3 ENG 2000/3000 Levels (Max. 2 2000 Levels)

1 CW Craft Course

2 CW Workshops

1 CW Publishing Seminar + thesis* OR 1 more Workshop

*If you are thinking of staying on for the fourth year and doing the **Capstone Thesis on the Creative Writing track**, the Publishing Seminar plus thesis is a mandatory prerequisite in the third year. (See requirements for the 4-year programme + Capstone Thesis below.)

ENG-CW MAJOR IN FOUR YEARS

20 Courses, 80 Credits

2 ENG Gateways (Forms of Literature + Introduction to Literary Theory)

3 ENG Surveys (of the four: Early British Literature, Literature in the Age of Empire, Indian Literatures, Postcolonial Literatures)

2 CW Gateways (Reading for Writing, Introduction to Creative Writing)

1 ENG Critical Thinking Seminar (CTS)

2 ENG 2000 Levels

3 ENG 3000 Levels

1 CW Craft Course

2 CW Workshops

1 CW Publishing Seminar plus thesis* OR 1 more Workshop

1 CW 4000 Level Critical Elective

2 ENG 4000 Levels/Proseminars**

* Mandatory for students on the Creative Writing track for the Capstone Thesis.

** Note on Proseminars: the Proseminar courses are mandatory for students doing their theses in English/Media Studies/Performing Arts, but are optional for students doing theses in Creative Writing.

ENG-CW MAJOR IN FOUR YEARS WITH CAPSTONE THESIS

20 Courses (80 Credits) + 12 Research Credits = 92 Credits

2 ENG Gateways (FOL + Lit Theory)

3 ENG Surveys (of the four: Early British Literature, Literature in the Age of Empire, Indian Literatures, Postcolonial Literatures)

2 CW Gateways (Reading for Writing, Introduction to Creative Writing)

1 ENG Critical Thinking Seminar (CTS)

2 ENG 2000 Levels

3 ENG 3000 Levels

1 CW Craft Course

2 CW Workshops

1 CW 4000 Level Critical Elective

1 CW Publishing Seminar with Thesis OR 1 more Workshop*

2 ENG 4000 Levels/Proseminars**

Research Credits:

English: Thesis + 2 Proseminars

Creative Writing: Capstone Thesis, Editing and Publishing Seminar, 4000 Level

Critical Elective

*Students on the Creative Writing track for the Capstone Thesis must have taken the Publishing Seminar plus thesis first. Students on the English track for the Capstone thesis may choose to take another Workshop course in place of the Publishing Seminar.

**NOTE on Proseminars: the Proseminar courses are mandatory for students doing their theses in English/Media Studies/Performing Arts, but are optional for students doing theses in Creative Writing.

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

- Students may choose to TA for the Creative Writing Department for 0, 2, or 4 academic credits based on their semester credit requirements.
- As per the Internship Policy, TAsip credits are eligible for Internship Credits.
- TAsip credits cannot be counted twice. They may either count as academic credits or internship credits.
- A TA will assist the professor in organising the course and ensuring smooth functioning of the same.

NOTE ON CROSSLISTS

- Students are allowed up to 2 crosslisted courses in the completion of the minor, concentration, and interdisciplinary major.
- In the case of ID majors, a cross-listed course can only count towards one of the departments, not both.
- If Department A of a crosslisted course is your major and Department B is your minor/concentration, the crosslist will count as credits taken in both departments.
- However, one course only counts for 4 credits towards overall degree requirements (separate from MM requirements), and therefore you will have to ensure you take enough overall credits.
- For a course to be crosslisted, the approval of the HoDs of both departments are required.